A GAZETTEER OF THE REACHES OF AUREVON

THE DWARVEN MOUNTAIN KINGDOM OF

GRUNVYR

The Deep Seat beneath the Great Anvil



VOLUME I · THE HOLD, ITS CROWN & ITS GRUDGES

A WARDEN'S GAZETTEER

Contents & Conceit

This volume describes the dwarven kingdom of Grunvyr, carved into the roots of Mount Varn-Karuld in the western Drakhammer Mountains, and the wider world of *Aurevon* in which it sits. It is written as an in-world gazetteer compiled by the Reckoners' College of Karad-Vyr, annotated for those who would set adventures within the Deep Seat — and is wholly invented, owing nothing to any existing setting.

Every name, date, and grudge herein is fictional. The kingdom is presented across thirteen short chapters: the world and its map; the shape of the kingdom; its history under the Deep Reckoning; the Stonecrown and its kings; government and the present succession crisis; coin and craft; the trade roads above and below; the seven great factions; the enemies that press upon the gates; and an appendix of names, rumours, and reckonings for quick reference at the table.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Read the history and factions first; nearly every adventure hook in Grunvyr grows from the **Ninthfall** and the quarrel over the sealed Ninth Delve. Statistics are deliberately system-neutral — translate them to your ruleset of choice.

I. The World of Aurevon 3

II. The Reaches — Map 4

III. Grunvyr at a Glance 5

IV. The Deep Reckoning — History 7

V. The Stonecrown — Rulers 9

VI. Government & Politics 11

VII. Coin, Craft & Economy 12

VIII. The Roads Above & Below 14

IX. Factions of the Deep 15

X. Enemies & Threats 17

XI. Appendix & Reckonings 19

CHAPTER I

The World of Aurevon

Aurevon is an old continent of granite spines and river-vales, where the great realms of dwarf, human, and the woodland folk of the Sylvan Pact have warred, traded, and intermarried their debts for three thousand years. Its heart is the **Drakhammer Mountains**, a vast north–south wall of basalt and granite that divides the temperate human kingdoms of the east from the broken wildlands of the west. Beneath the Drakhammer burns the *Emberdeeps*, a region of magma-veins and metal so rich that whoever holds it holds the wealth of half the world. Grunvyr holds it.

The known powers of the Reaches — the stretch of Aurevon within a month's travel of the Deep Seat — are few but jealous. To the east, along the wide **River Vael**, lies the human **Kingdom of Vendholm**, a rising mercantile crown grown fat on grain, river-tolls, and the trade it brokers between the dwarves and the wider continent. To the south, the foothill dwarf-hold of **Dûn Khorvald**, Grunvyr's poorer cousin, clings to the lower passes. To the west and north spread the **Skarn Wastes**, home to the raiding confederacy of the same name. Deep in the eastern forests lie the closed borders of the **Sylvan Pact of Eldwynne**, whose folk trade rare timber and reagents but admit few outsiders.

The Shape of the Reaches

Travel in Aurevon is governed by water and stone. The Vael is the great artery of the east, navigable by barge from the foothill port of **Aldermouth** down to the continental city of **Caer Ostryn**. Inland, the only reliable ways through the Drakhammer are the dwarf-cut roads and the treacherous **Karth Pass** in the north, snowbound half the year. This is why Grunvyr matters far beyond its size: it sits astride the only deep, all-weather route through the mountains — the subterranean **Emberway** — and every crown in the Reaches has reason to court, cheat, or covet it.

THE RECKONING OF YEARS

Aurevon's peoples keep different calendars. This gazetteer uses the dwarven **Deep Reckoning** (**D.R.**), counted from the founding of Grunvyr. The present year is **D.R. 1622**. Humans of Vendholm reckon the same year as 884 of the River Crown; the Reckoners note both in the margins of every contract, for a misdated debt is a forgiven debt.

Powers of the Day

THE KINGDOM OF VENDHOLM

A young, ambitious human realm under **Margrave Aldric Vossheim**, who styles himself "Warden of the River." Vendholm grew wealthy as the middleman of dwarven trade and resents that Grunvyr now seeks to deal with Caer Ostryn directly. It is Grunvyr's largest creditor and its most dangerous friend.

DÛN KHORVALD

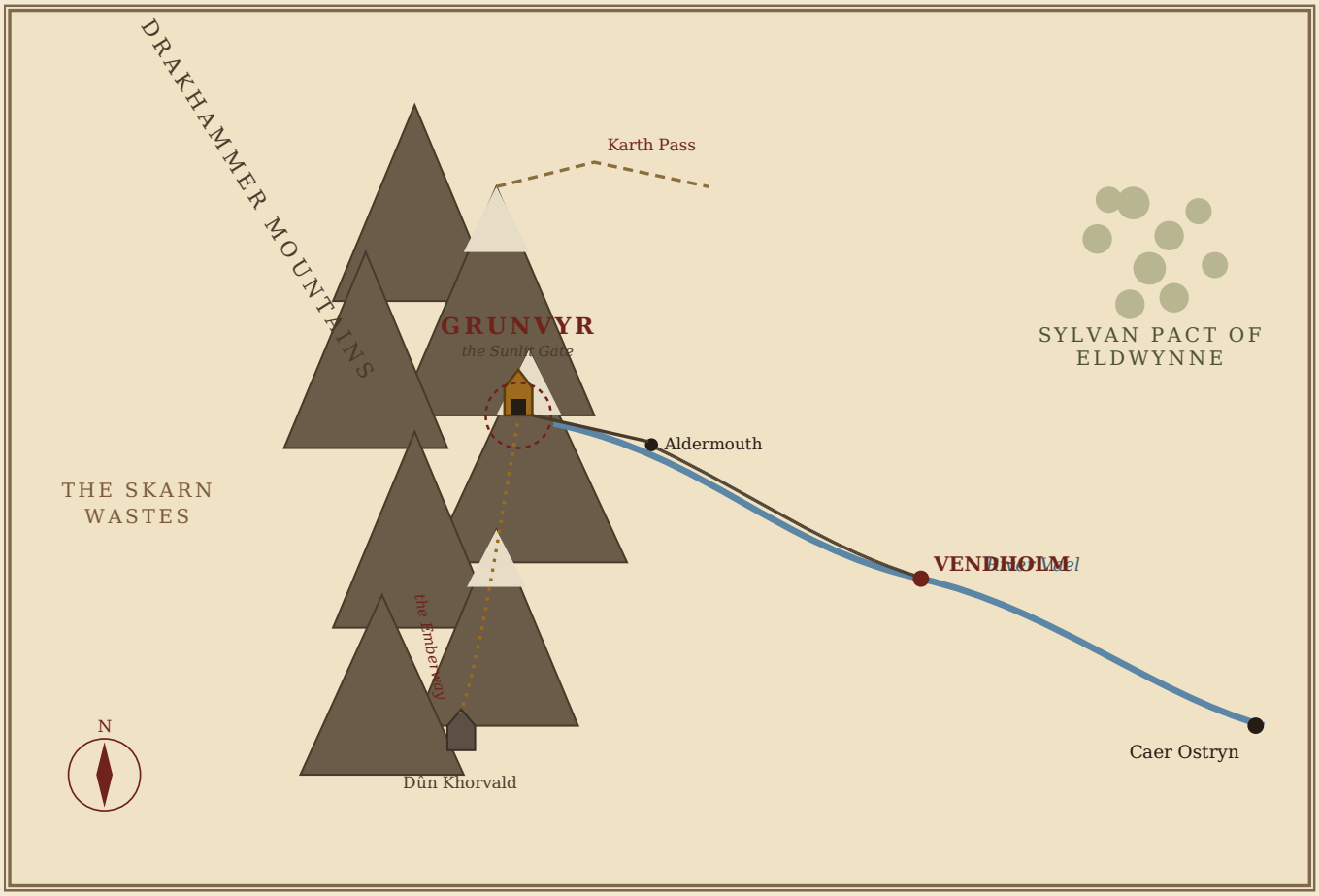
A smaller dwarf-hold three days south along the Emberway, ruled by the **Stewards of the Lower Gate**. Khorvald mines coal and iron but no aurithal, and depends on Grunvyr for finished goods. Their loyalty is real but their pride is bruised; many in Khorvald believe the Stonecrown ought, by old oath, to pass to their line should Grunvyr's fail.

THE SKARN CONFEDERATION

Not a kingdom but a shifting alliance of warbands out of the western wastes, presently bound under the warlord **Vargûl Ash-Tongue**. The Skarn raid the Karth Pass each thaw, less for plunder than for the iron and salt they cannot mine themselves.

CHAPTER II

The Reaches of Aurevon



THE REACHES OF AUREVON — DRAWN BY THE RECKONERS' COLLEGE, D.R. 1620

The map above shows the Reaches as the Reckoners chart them: the Drakhammer running as a diagonal wall, with Grunvyr's **Sunlit Gate** opening eastward toward the river-port of Aldermouth and, beyond it, the human crown of Vendholm on the Vael. The dotted gold line tracing south is the **Emberway**, the deep road to Dûn Khorvald. The northern dashed track is the seasonal **Karth Pass**, the only overland crossing — and the Skarn Wastes press against it from the west.

CHAPTER III

Grunvyr at a Glance

THE DEEP SEAT — QUICK FACTS		
Realm The Mountain Kingdom of Grunvyr	**Royal Hold** Karad-Vyr, the Hall of Hearths	**Founded** D.R. 1, by Grun Vyr the Stonefather
Ruler Underking Vargin III Vyr (failing)	**Population** ~62,000 dwarves; ~4,000 resident outlanders	**Government** Elective monarchy + the Clan-Moot
Wealth Aurithal, thromsilver, gems, fine craft	**Tongue** Khazic (Deep-tongue); trade-Aurevish	**Faith** The Stonefather, Vaurda the Forge-Mother

Grunvyr is not a city but a vertical kingdom — nine great levels, called *Delves*, descending from the surface gate down toward the magma of the Emberdeeps. Eight Delves are inhabited and worked. The ninth was sealed in catastrophe four centuries ago, and the whole politics of the realm still turns, in the end, upon that sealed door.

The kingdom is reached from the surface only through the **Sunlit Gate** (Vaur-Khaz), a fortified bastion where the Highgate Road meets the mountain. Outlanders rarely pass deeper than the Gate's trade-halls; the kingdom proper begins below.

The Nine Delves

I. THE SUNLIT GATE (VAUR-KHAZ)

The surface bastion and customs-hold. Embassies, caravanserais, the foreign quarter, and the toll-houses of House Goldhand. The only level outsiders see freely.

II. THE HALL OF HEARTHS (KARAD-VYR)

The royal and governmental tier. Here sit the Stonecrown's throne, the Moot-Hall of the clans, the Council of Hammers, and the ancestral hearth-shrines of the great clans.

III. THE FORGEWORKS (DVUR-ALDÛN)

A roaring tier of furnaces, water-driven trip-hammers, and the guild-halls of the Forgewrights. The aurithal is worked here, and the air glows.

IV. THE VAULTS (KHAZAD-THROM)

The treasury and banking tier. House Goldhand's counting-halls, the royal reserve, and the deed-vaults where the Book of Reckonings is kept under lock and oath.

V–VII. THE DELVINGS

Three tiers of active mines and worker-warrens, home to the great mass of the Delvers' Union. The deeper one goes, the richer the seams — and the closer the heat.

VIII. THE UNDERHALL (THROM-VAEL)

The deepest worked level, on the threshold of the Emberdeeps. Garrisoned by the Deepward Order. Few but wardens and the boldest delvers go here.

IX. THE NINTH DELVE (THROM-DÛL) — SEALED

Once the richest level of all. Collapsed and sealed in the Ninthfall of D.R. 1187. Behind its great basalt door lie the dead, the lost treasure of the High Age, and — the Deepward swear — the Gloamkin.

A VERTICAL PEOPLE

To a dwarf of Grunvyr, "up" means poorer and safer; "down" means richer and deadlier. Status is measured in how deep one's clan-hearth lies. The royal Vyr keep their hearth on the Second Delve — close enough to the surface to rule, deep enough to be honoured.

CHAPTER IV

The Deep Reckoning

Dwarves measure time in grudges settled and seams exhausted. The history of Grunvyr divides into five ages, each remembered by the Reckoners' College in the great ledger called the Deep Reckoning, from which this account is drawn.

The Founding (D.R. 1–600)

In the first year of the Reckoning, the clan-chief **Grun Vyr**, called the Stonefather, led seven clans into the roots of Mount Varn-Karuld, fleeing a war on the surface whose cause the Reckoners no longer record (and, some whisper, deliberately struck from the ledger). They cut the first three Delves, struck iron and good stone, and swore the **Oath of the Seven Hearths** that binds the great clans to this day. Grun ruled two hundred years and was entombed, by his own command, in the deepest gallery then dug — a grave that would later lie within the doomed Ninth Delve.

The Age of Anvils (D.R. 600–1180)

The middle age was Grunvyr's long industrious dawn. In **D.R. 742** a delver of Clan Emberkin struck the first vein of **aurithal** — the golden sky-metal, light as bronze and stronger than steel, that takes an enchantment as wet clay takes a thumbprint. Aurithal made Grunvyr famous and rich. The Forgewrights' Guild rose to power; House Goldhand began to mint coin trusted from the Wastes to the sea; the surface road was cut and the Sunlit Gate raised in **D.R. 905**.

By **D.R. 1100** the dwarves had opened eight Delves and begun the ninth, the deepest shaft ever sunk in Aurevon, chasing a seam of aurithal richer than any before it down toward the heat of the Emberdeeps.

ON AURITHAL

Aurithal is the foundation of every fact in this book — the source of Grunvyr's wealth, its enemies' envy, and its debts. No surface kingdom has ever found a vein of it. The only known deposits lie in the Emberdeeps, and the richest of all lay in the Ninth Delve. This is why the sealed door will not stay an academic matter.

The Ninthfall (D.R. 1187)

In the spring of **D.R. 1187**, the deep-delvers of the Ninth broke through into a vast natural cavern no pick had made — and something came out of it. The Reckoners' ledger for that year is written in a shaking hand and uses one word again and again: *gloaming*. Within a season the Ninth Delve was overrun by pale, blind, stone-eating things the dwarves named the **Gloamkin**. Thousands died. The Eighth was nearly lost.

> *"We did not seal the door to keep the Gloamkin in the dark. We sealed it because we could not bear to look at what our greed had woken."*
>
> — ATTRIBUTED TO DURMÛR IV, THE SEALER

The reigning Underking, **Durmûr IV**, made the hardest choice in the kingdom's history: he ordered the Ninth Delve collapsed and its survivors abandoned, then had the great basalt **Sealing Door** raised across the shaft and bound with oath and aurithal. He thereby saved the kingdom and damned his name; to this day "to make a Durmûr's choice" means to save the many by sacrificing the trapped few.

The Long Shoring (D.R. 1187–1450)

For nearly three centuries Grunvyr turned inward, shoring up its remaining Delves, mourning, and rationing the aurithal it could no longer freely mine. Trade dwindled; the kingdom nearly forgot the surface. The Deepward Order was founded in **D.R. 1206** to garrison the Eighth and watch the Sealing Door — a duty it has never relinquished.

The Trade Awakening (D.R. 1450–present)

Under **Underqueen Hesla II**, Grunvyr reopened the Sunlit Gate in **D.R. 1458** and began again to sell its

hoarded craft to a surface world that had grown hungry for it. The Merchant Concord was chartered; Vendholm rose as middleman; debts were taken on to fund new works. The kingdom grew rich again — but on borrowed coin and dwindling aurithal, and the whole edifice now rests on a question no one will say aloud: **what if the door were opened?**

TIMELINE OF THE DEEP RECKONING

YEAR (D.R.)	EVENT
1	Grun Vyr the Stonefather leads the Seven Clans into Varn-Karuld; the Oath of the Seven Hearths is sworn.
742	First vein of aurithal struck by Clan Emberkin. The Age of Anvils begins in earnest.
905	The Sunlit Gate is raised; the Highgate Road completed to Aldermouth.
1100	Eight Delves complete; digging of the Ninth begins.
1187	**The Ninthfall.** The Gloamkin emerge; Durmûr IV seals the Ninth Delve.
1206	The Deepward Order founded to garrison the Eighth Delve.
1458	Underqueen Hesla II reopens the Sunlit Gate; the Trade Awakening begins.
1539	The Merchant Concord chartered; first great loans taken from Vendholm.
1604	The Skarn under Vargûl Ash-Tongue close the Karth Pass for two years.
1622	**The present.** Underking Vargin III fails; the succession is open and the Reclaimers grow bold.

CHAPTER V

The Stonecrown

The crown of Grunvyr is a circlet of black iron set with a single fist-sized bead of aurithal, called the **Stonecrown**. It does not pass by simple birth. By the Oath of the Seven Hearths, each new monarch must be of the blood of Grun Vyr — but must also be *confirmed* by the Clan-Moot, the assembly of the great clans. In nineteen reigns the Moot has thrice passed over a king's own child for a worthier cousin, and that possibility is the engine of all dwarven politics.

Monarchs take the title **Underking** or **Underqueen**. They reign until death — and dwarves live two and a half centuries — so reigns are long, and a contested succession is a generational wound.

The Line of Vyr

Nineteen monarchs have worn the Stonecrown. The Reckoners record them all; a few decided the shape of the kingdom and bear remembering.

KINGS WORTH KNOWING

Grun I, the Stonefather (r. D.R. 1–201): Founder. Entombed in the deep gallery now lost behind the Sealing Door — a grave the Reclaimers long to recover.

Durmûr IV, the Sealer (r. 1170–1219): Sealed the Ninth Delve in the Ninthfall. Revered and reviled. The Deepward keep his memory; the Reclaimers curse it.

Hesla II, the Opener (r. 1441–1502): Reopened the Sunlit Gate and the surface trade. Mother of the modern kingdom — and of its debts.

Vargin III (r. 1561–present): The aging present king. Childless, ailing, and unwilling to name an heir, he has left the Moot to fight over his crown while he still breathes.

The Present Succession

Underking Vargin III is two hundred and forty years old and failing. He has no living children. By custom the Moot will choose his successor from among the blood of Vyr, and two cousins have emerged as rivals — each backed by a different vision of what Grunvyr should become.

THANE DAGRA IRONVOW

Mistress of the Forgeworks and head of Clan Ironvow, Dagra is the candidate of the Merchant Concord and the younger Forgewrights. She would open Grunvyr wider to the world: more trade, more aurithal sold abroad, debts refinanced, the Sunlit Gate enlarged. Her enemies call her "the Pawnbroker's Queen" and warn she would sell the mountain out from under its own people.

THANE KORROTH DEEPWARD

Warden of the Deeps and a sworn brother of the Deepward Order, Korroth is the traditionalist. He would close the Gate, repudiate the Vendholm debts, and — most dangerously — **reconquer the Ninth Delve**, drive out the Gloamkin, and reclaim the lost aurithal and the Stonefather's tomb. His followers see a hero; his rivals see a zealot who would loose the horror that nearly ended the kingdom.

THE CROWN IN THE BALANCE

Neither candidate yet holds a majority of the Moot's seven clan-votes. **House Goldhand** is undecided and therefore decisive — and Goldhand holds the kingdom's debts. Whoever wins Goldhand likely wins the Stonecrown. This is the single most exploitable fact in the kingdom for any ambitious party — including outsiders.

THE SEVEN VOTES OF THE CLAN-MOOT

CLAN	DOMAIN	LEANING
Vyr	The royal line; the Stonecrown	Vargin III names no heir
Ironvow	The Forgeworks; mastery of aurithal	Dagra (reform)
Deepward	The Eighth Delve; the wardens	Korroth (tradition)
Goldhand	The Vaults; coin and debt	**Undecided — decisive**
Stonewright	Builders, engineers, the Delves	Leans reform
Khazmar	The Delvers' Union; the mines	Restive; leans tradition
Emberkin	First finders of aurithal; old prestige	Split; courted by both

CHAPTER VI

Government & Politics

Grunvyr is ruled by three bodies whose powers overlap by design, so that no single one may master the mountain: the **Stonecrown**, the **Clan-Moot**, and the **Council of Hammers**. In quiet years they balance one another. In a succession year — like this one — they grind.

The Stonecrown (the Monarch)

The Underking commands the army and the Deepward, mints the coin, conducts foreign treaties, and holds final judgement in matters of blood and grudge. But the monarch cannot levy a new tax, open or seal a Delve, or alter the great Oaths without the Moot's assent. A weak or dying king — as now — leaves a vacuum the other bodies rush to fill.

The Clan-Moot

The assembly of the seven great clans, each casting one vote through its **Hearth-Thane**. The Moot confirms each new monarch, passes the great laws, ratifies treaties and loans, and alone may vote to open a sealed Delve. Its seven votes are listed in the previous chapter; at present they are split three ways with Goldhand holding the balance.

The Council of Hammers

The kingdom's executive — the heads of its great institutions, who carry out the day's governing:

- **The Forge-Master** — head of the Forgewrights' Guild (currently Dagra Ironvow herself).
- **The Vault-Keeper** — head of House Goldhand; master of the treasury and the debts.
- **The Deep-Warden** — commander of the Deepward Order (currently Korroth Deepward).
- **The Gate-Warden** — keeper of the Sunlit Gate, customs, and the foreign quarter.
- **The High Reckoner** — head of the Reckoners' College; keeper of the calendar, the law, and the Book of Reckonings.

That two of the five Hammers — the Forge-Master and the Deep-Warden — are also the two royal claimants tells you everything about why the Council can barely agree to light its own furnaces this year.

THE BOOK OF RECKONINGS

Every debt, oath, grudge, and judgement in Grunvyr is recorded by the Reckoners in the Book of Reckonings, kept in the Vaults. A grudge unrecorded is not a grudge; a debt unrecorded cannot be collected. The High Reckoner who keeps the Book is, quietly, one of the most powerful figures in the kingdom — for the Book records who owes what to whom, and the Reckoners decide what the Book says.

The Fault-Lines

Three quarrels run beneath all dwarven politics this year, and any campaign set in Grunvyr will turn on at least one of them.

OPEN OR SEALED

The defining question. The reform party (Concord, Ironvow, the younger Forgewrights) would open the kingdom wider to trade and even consider reopening the Ninth for its aurithal. The tradition party (Deepward, much of the Khazmar miners) would seal the realm tighter and let the dead lie. Korroth Deepward's wish to *reconquer* the Ninth is a strange third position — traditionalist in spirit, yet it would do the one thing the Sealer forbade.

DEBT & THE FOREIGN HAND

Grunvyr owes Vendholm and the surface houses a great and growing sum, brokered through Goldhand. Reformers say trade will pay it down; traditionalists say the debt is a leash in Margrave Vossheim's hand. Both are right.

THE RESTLESS DELVERS

The Delvers' Union (Clan Khazmar) does the deadliest work for the least power — one vote in the Moot for the majority of the kingdom's bodies. Talk of a **tool-down** (a strike) grows in the lower Delves, and a kingdom that cannot mine cannot pay its debts.

CHAPTER VII

Coin, Craft & Economy

Grunvyr is wealthy in everything but the one thing it cannot make underground: food. It exports metal, gems, mechanisms, and the finest craft in Aurevon; it imports grain, timber, livestock, and wine. This single dependency — bread for blades — shapes its every road and treaty.

What the Mountain Yields

AURITHAL — THE GOLDEN STEEL

The prestige metal of the world: light, immensely strong, and uniquely able to hold enchantment. Found nowhere but the Emberdeeps. Grunvyr's reserves dwindle with the Ninth Delve sealed; the kingdom now mines a fraction of its High-Age output, which is precisely why both its wealth and its succession hinge on that door.

THROMSILVER

A bright, corrosion-proof silver-grey metal, less rare than aurithal but the backbone of Grunvyr's everyday trade: tools, fittings, fine wire, and the famed thromsilver locks no surface thief has yet picked.

EMBERGLASS & GEMS

The heat of the deep Delves yields fire-opals and a prized volcanic crystal called *emberglass*, cut into lenses, lamps, and ornament.

CRAFT & ALE

Grunvyr's true export is skill: clockwork mechanisms, locks, masonry, and weapons. And from the Hearthbrewers comes **Deepfire**, a black stout aged in aurithal-banded casks, worth its weight in silver on the surface.

THE COIN OF GRUNVYR

Minted by House Goldhand and trusted from the Wastes to the sea:

- **The Mark** — gold; the standard of large trade. Stamped with the Anvil.
- **The Shard** — silver; 12 to the Mark. Daily coin.
- **The Bit** — copper; 12 to the Shard.

Goldhand's promissory notes — "Goldhand paper" — circulate across Aurevon, often trusted above kings' own coin.

The Great Guilds & Houses

Economic power in Grunvyr runs through five bodies, several of which double as political clans:

- **The Forgewrights' Guild** — masters of metal and the aurithal monopoly; the most prestigious body in the realm.
- **House Goldhand** — bankers, minters, and toll-keepers; hold the kingdom's debts and much of its leverage.
- **The Delvers' Union** — the miners; vast in number, poor in power, and increasingly angry.
- **The Stoneholders' Guild** — engineers and masons who keep the Delves from collapsing; quietly indispensable.
- **The Hearthbrewers** — the ale-makers; small, rich, and beloved enough that no faction dares offend them.

PRINCIPAL GOODS OF GRUNVYR

EXPORT	BOUND FOR	RELATIVE VALUE	IMPORT (IN RETURN)
Aurithal goods & enchanted arms	Vendholm, Caer Ostryn	Very high	Refined grain, hard coin
Thromsilver tools & locks	All the Reaches	High	Timber, leather
Emberglass & cut gems	Caer Ostryn, Eldwynne	High	Reagents, rare woods
Clockwork & mechanisms	Vendholm	Moderate	Livestock, textiles
Deepfire stout	Everywhere it can reach	Moderate	Wine, salt
Coal & raw iron (from Khorvald)	Internal use	Low	—

CHAPTER VIII

The Roads Above & Below

Five great routes carry Grunvyr's wealth to the world and bread to the mountain. Three run above ground and are hostage to weather, war, and tariff; two run below and are the kingdom's quiet strategic treasure. Every route is also a vulnerability, and any of them can be the spine of an adventure.

The Surface Roads

THE HIGHGATE ROAD

The main artery: from the Sunlit Gate down the eastern slope to the river-port of **Aldermouth**, where dwarven goods are loaded onto Vael barges. Vendholm collects a toll at Aldermouth on everything that passes — a steady grievance and the chief reason the Concord dreams of dealing with Caer Ostryn directly.

THE KARTH PASS

The only overland crossing of the northern Drakhammer, linking Grunvyr to the upland trade in furs, timber, and northern silver. Snowbound from late autumn to spring, and harried by the Skarn each thaw. When the Skarn closed it for two years (D.R. 1604–06), northern prices doubled.

THE GLIMMERWEND

Not a road but the river-and-canal route down the Vael from Aldermouth to **Caer Ostryn**, the great city of the lower river. Gems and fine craft go down; wine, salt, and coin come up. Controlled at every lock by Vendholm's customs.

The Deep Roads

THE EMBERWAY

Grunvyr's masterwork and best-kept advantage: a deep, dwarf-cut road running south through the mountain's roots to **Dûn Khorvald**, immune to weather and hidden from surface armies. Coal and iron come north; finished goods go south. In war, the Emberway is the route no enemy can close — so long as Khorvald stays loyal.

THE UNDERFENT

A half-mapped tangle of older, natural passages branching off the Emberway, used by smugglers, the Reclaimers, and worse. The Deepward patrol what they can. Some of the Underfent, the wardens fear, connects to the sealed Ninth.

THE TRADE ROUTES OF GRUNVYR

ROUTE	RUNS	CARRIES	HAZARD
Highgate Road	Sunlit Gate → Aldermouth	Main exports; bread back	Vendholm tolls; bandits
Karth Pass	North Drakhammer → uplands	Furs, timber, N. silver	Snow; Skarn raids
Glimmerwend	Aldermouth → Caer Ostryn	Gems, fine craft; wine, salt	Lock tolls; river pirates
Emberway	Grunvyr → Dûn Khorvald	Coal/iron up; goods down	Khorvald's loyalty; the deep dark
Underfent	Branches off the Emberway	Smuggling; the unlawful	Unmapped; Gloamkin?

CHAPTER IX

Factions of the Deep

Seven powers contend for the soul of Grunvyr. Each wants something specific from the present crisis; their aims cross and tangle, and a clever party can play any against any. Each entry gives the faction's aim, its strength, and the lever by which it may be moved.

THE MERCHANT CONCORD

Aim: open the kingdom — more trade, direct dealings with Caer Ostryn, the debts refinanced and the Gate enlarged. Backs Dagra Ironvow for the Stonecrown.
Strength: coin, foreign contacts, and the loyalty of the younger generation.
Lever: they need the debt resolved on good terms; a party who can renegotiate Vendholm's tolls earns the Concord's gratitude — and gold.

THE DEEPWARD ORDER

Aim: guard the Sealing Door and the Eighth Delve; preserve the old ways. Backs Korroth Deepward — though some wardens are uneasy at his wish to *open* the very door they are sworn to keep shut.
Strength: the kingdom's finest warriors and the only force that has faced the Gloamkin and lived.
Lever: their oath is to contain the horror, not to crown a king; show them Korroth would loose it, and their loyalty fractures.

HOUSE GOLDHAND

Aim: whatever keeps the debts paid and the coin sound. Officially neutral in the succession — and therefore courted by all.
Strength: the treasury, the mint, the Vaults, and the decisive seventh vote.
Lever: Goldhand follows the ledger. Prove which claimant best secures their loans and you have moved the kingdom.

THE FORGEWRIGHTS' GUILD

Aim: protect the aurithal monopoly and the guild's prestige. Split between "newforgers" (who would experiment and expand) and traditional masters.
Strength: control of the kingdom's signature craft and the secret of working aurithal.
Lever: the dwindling aurithal supply terrifies them; a new source — or the Ninth's — would buy their souls.

THE DELVERS' UNION

Aim: better pay, danger-coin for deep work, and a real voice in the Moot.
Strength: numbers — they are most of the kingdom — and the simple fact that nothing is mined without them.
Lever: they are on the edge of a tool-down. Whoever wins the miners' trust gains a force no coin can buy; whoever ignores them risks the mines going silent.

THE RECKONERS' COLLEGE

Aim: keep the law, the calendar, and the Book of Reckonings — and, quietly, keep certain truths about the Ninthfall buried.
Strength: knowledge, the Book, and the trust of every party that needs a debt recorded or a grudge judged.
Lever: the Reckoners know what really came out of the Ninth. That knowledge is the most dangerous secret in Grunvyr, and they will deal to protect it.

THE RECLAIMERS (THE NINTHBORN)

Aim: reopen the Ninth Delve — to recover the Stonefather's tomb, the lost aurithal, and the abandoned dead they call kin.
Strength: zeal, secrecy, and growing sympathy as the aurithal runs short and Korroth's rhetoric spreads.
Lever: they are heretics to most and martyrs to themselves. Some are grieving descendants of the trapped; some are something colder. Not all of them, the Reckoners fear, are still entirely dwarves.

WHO STANDS WITH WHOM

The Reform bloc: Merchant Concord · Clan Ironvow · the newforgers · (leaning) Stonewright. **Champion:** Dagra Ironvow.

The Tradition bloc: Deepward Order · much of Clan Khazmar · old Forgewright masters. **Champion:** Korroth Deepward.

The wild cards: House Goldhand (decisive, neutral), the Reckoners (secret-keepers), the Delvers' Union (restive), and the Reclaimers (heretics who would make either bloc's victory irrelevant by opening the door themselves).

CHAPTER X

Enemies & Threats

Grunvyr is pressed from below, from without, and from within. The wise Warden will note that no single enemy can destroy the kingdom — but any two acting together might, and the kingdom's own factions keep handing them the opportunity.

From Below — The Gloamkin

The existential dread of Grunvyr. Pale, eyeless, and patient, the Gloamkin emerged from the cavern beyond the Ninth Delve in D.R. 1187 and have dwelt behind the Sealing Door ever since. They eat stone and flesh alike, move in a cold silence the dwarves call the *gloaming*, and seem governed by some older intelligence the Reckoners will not name in full.

For four centuries the Sealing Door has held. But the aurithal that binds it is, like all the kingdom's aurithal, slowly being spent — and the Underfent may already offer them a path around it. Every plot to reopen the Ninth, whether Korroth's reconquest or the Reclaimers' devotion, is in truth a plot to let the Gloamkin out.

RUNNING THE GLOAMKIN

The Gloamkin work best as creeping horror, not a standing army: cold spots in the deep Delves, stone gone soft and chalky, delvers who wander into the dark and return changed and quiet. Save their full emergence for a campaign's climax — the moment a faction finally opens the door.

From Without — The Skarn

The Skarn Confederation of the western Wastes, bound for now under **Vargûl Ash-Tongue**, is the surface threat. They cannot breach the Sunlit Gate, but they do not need to: they strangle the Karth Pass, raid the upland caravans, and grow bolder as Grunvyr's attention turns inward to its succession. Vargûl is no mere brute — he has begun, ominously, to send envoys rather than raiders, and to ask after the kingdom's debts and quarrels.

From the East — Vendholm

Margrave Aldric Vossheim of Vendholm is the most dangerous enemy precisely because he is officially a friend. He holds Grunvyr's debts, taxes its trade at Aldermouth, and would like nothing better than a weak and divided dwarven crown beholden to his coin. He need not conquer Grunvyr; he need only own it. A reformist Stonecrown that opens the kingdom plays into his hand as surely as a traditionalist one that defaults on his loans gives him a casus belli.

From Within — The Deep Schism

The most immediate threat is the kingdom's own division. A contested succession, a restless miners' union one grievance from a tool-down, a heretic sect working in the dark to open the one door that must stay shut, and a treasury mortgaged to a rival crown — Grunvyr's enemies need only wait, and nudge. The Reclaimers are the sharp edge of this: should they reach the Sealing Door before the Moot settles the crown, the question of who rules Grunvyr may be answered by what comes out of the Ninth.

THREATS AT A GLANCE

THREAT	NATURE	WANTS	PRESSURE POINT
The Gloamkin	Subterranean horror	Out	The Sealing Door; the Underfent
The Skarn	Surface raiders	Iron, salt, leverage	The Karth Pass
Vendholm	Rival crown / creditor	A dwarven crown it owns	The debts; Aldermouth tolls
The Reclaimers	Internal heretics	To reopen the Ninth	The succession; the Underfent
The Deep Schism	Civil division	(it merely needs to continue)	The empty throne

CHAPTER XI

Appendix & Reckonings

A Gazetteer of Names

For quick reference at the table. All are invented for this kingdom.

PEOPLE

- **Vargin III Vyr** — the failing Underking; childless, irresolute.
- **Dagra Ironvow** — Forge-Master; reform claimant to the Stonecrown.
- **Korroth Deepward** — Deep-Warden; tradition claimant; would reconquer the Ninth.
- **Durmûr IV, the Sealer** — long-dead king who sealed the Ninth.
- **Grun Vyr, the Stonefather** — founder; entombed behind the Sealing Door.
- **Hesla II, the Opener** — reopened the surface trade.
- **Margrave Aldric Vossheim** — ruler of Vendholm; Grunvyr's creditor.
- **Vargûl Ash-Tongue** — warlord of the Skarn Confederation.

PLACES

- **Karad-Vyr** — the royal hold; the Hall of Hearths (2nd Delve).
- **Vaur-Khaz** — the Sunlit Gate; surface bastion and customs.
- **Dvur-Aldûn** — the Forgeworks (3rd Delve).
- **Khazad-Throm** — the Vaults (4th Delve).
- **Throm-Dûl** — the sealed Ninth Delve.
- **Aldermouth** — Vendholm river-port; toll-point.
- **Dûn Khorvald** — cousin dwarf-hold to the south.

THINGS & TERMS

- **Aurithal** — golden sky-steel; the kingdom's wealth.
- **The Stonecrown** — the iron-and-aurithal crown; the throne itself.
- **The Book of Reckonings** — the ledger of all debts and grudges.
- **A Durmûr's choice** — to save the many by abandoning the trapped few.
- **The gloaming** — the cold silence that heralds the Gloamkin.

ADVENTURE SEEDS (ROLL D8)

1	A Reckoner hires the party to recover a page torn from the Book of Reckonings — a page that names who really opened the Ninth.
2	House Goldhand will name its candidate if someone renegotiates Vendholm's tolls at Aldermouth. Both claimants want the party to fail.
3	The Delvers' Union calls a tool-down. The mines fall silent; a debt payment to Vendholm comes due in ten days.
4	A delver returns from the lower Delves changed — quiet, cold, and asking the way to the Sealing Door.
5	Korroth Deepward asks the party to map the Underfent "for defence." Dagra Ironvow asks them to report what he finds.
6	Vargûl Ash-Tongue sends an envoy under truce-oath, offering to lift the Karth Pass blockade — in exchange for aurithal.
7	The Reclaimers offer the party the Stonefather's lost burial-map. The Reckoners offer more to burn it.
8	Underking Vargin III dies in the night. The Moot has three days to choose, and the Sealing Door has begun, very faintly, to hum.

> *"Grunvyr was not built to last forever. It was built to last long enough to settle every debt. The trouble, child, is that the deepest debt of all still sits behind a door we swore never to open — and the ledger always, always comes due."*
>
> — HIGH RECKONER MAEVIS STONELEDGER, TO HER APPRENTICE

HERE ENDS VOLUME I OF THE GAZETTEER OF GRUNVYR
❖ THE DEEP RECKONING · D.R. 1622 ❖